

G R Infraprojects Limited: Turns to Google Cloud to run business- critical SAP S/4HANA ERP system

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ABOUT G R



About G R Infraprojects Limited

With Google Cloud, G R Infraprojects Limited has moved its business-critical SAP S/4HANA system to the cloud, making it scalable, resilient, and secure. This move will help the company run its infrastructure at a lower cost than alternative options. The orga

G R Infraprojects Limited is an integrated road engineering, procurement, and construction company that designs and constructs roads across India. Its business operations are divided into civil construction activities, under which it provides engineering, procurement, and construction services; development of roads and highways on a build-operate-transfer basis; and manufacturing activities that include the processing of bitumen, the manufacture of thermoplastic road-marking paint and road

has also established a robust platform to take remaining workloads to the cloud in the coming

signage, and the fabrication and galvanizing of metal crash barriers.

Industries: Real Estate & Construction

Location: India

Google Cloud results

- Cut infrastructure administration load by moving to the cloud
- Protects key systems and data with cloud-based security
- Enables seamless control of speed and availability on a daily basis

Reduced S/4H infrastructure costs with Google Cloud

Google Cloud (<https://cloud.google.com/>)

Compute Engine
(<https://cloud.google.com/compute/>)

Cloud Storage (<https://cloud.google.com/storage/>)

Road construction is booming in India. A recent [report](https://www.ibef.org/industry/roads-presentation) (<https://www.ibef.org/industry/roads-presentation>) prepared by the India Brand Equity Foundation—a trust established by the Department of Commerce—

pointed out that in FY 2019 alone, the country added 10,855 kilometers of highways to a road network that spans 5.89 million kilometers. This network is the second largest in the world and transports 90% of passenger traffic and 64.5% of all goods in the country.

The Indian Government has also earmarked road construction as key to plans to increase the nation's GDP to \$5 trillion in coming years, targeting road construction worth \$212.8 billion in the two years from April 2020.

G R Infraprojects Limited (<https://grinfra.com/>) is well positioned to support the government's program. The business, which started as a contractor building roads in rural villages in India, now specializes in road engineering, procurement, and construction (EPC), a model whereby private construction firms build roads funded by the government.

The business now undertakes the processing of bitumen, manufacture of thermoplastic road-marking paint and road signage, and fabrication and galvanizing road-crash barriers. Its in-house integration model includes a design and engineering team, as well as manufacturing facilities in Rajasthan, Assam, and Gujarat.

The business recently expanded into rail—another area expected to benefit from extensive government investment—with its competencies including earthworks, materials supply, track lining, and bridge construction.

In this environment—and despite the economic impact of the coronavirus pandemic—G R Infraprojects Limited aims to substantially increase turnover and manpower over the next five years.



Best-in-class infrastructure key to success

Digital transformation is key to enabling growth while best-in-class IT infrastructure is one of the foundations on which the business seeks to build success.

G R Infraprojects Limited's digital initiatives include deployment of a new document management system and corporate systems that enable remote monitoring, live tracking, effective real-time communication, and efficient data management.

Providing a scalable, reliable cost-effective infrastructure

But most important of all is providing a scalable, reliable, and cost-effective infrastructure to support a business-critical SAP enterprise resource planning system. Over the last few years, versions of SAP have enabled the organization to digitize processes and seamlessly run business-critical functions such as inventory management and finance.

G R Infraprojects Limited initially went live with SAP ECC6.0, with a few hundred team members using the system for business-critical tasks such as tracking stock level and movement and generating financial statements and reports for review and action.

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*—Sachin Kumar Agarwal,
Head, Transformation, G
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Lowering maintenance costs

However, as G R Infraprojects Limited grew, projects proliferated, and new markets emerged, the business elected to move to the cloud from an on-premises infrastructure. “We wanted to move because there were so many maintenance costs in on-premises solutions and cloud provided convenience to IT and the broader organization,” explains Sachin Kumar Agarwal, Head, Transformation at G R Infraprojects Limited.

The business also wanted to move to SAP S/4HANA to take advantage of features such as AI, advanced analytics, and machine learning to transform business processes. The system runs on the HANA database, an in-memory database with fast processing speeds and a simplified data model.

G R Infraprojects Limited selected Google Cloud (<https://cloud.google.com/>) to run SAP S/4HANA (/solutions/sap) because, Sachin says, it is “much better than any other platform,” incorporates a wide range of features, and meets uptime requirements. The cloud service could also scale to support forecast growth without a sharp increase in cost.

Furthermore, Sachin adds, “Google Cloud is a very big brand, so we were easily able to secure the trust

from our executive and business teams to run an important system such as SAP S/4HANA on the platform.”

“With Google Cloud, our speed and availability are controlled and optimized day by day. With such a scalable and dynamic platform, we are very happy with the performance.”

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Successful transition with Infrabeat

G R Infraprojects Limited completed the project with assistance from partner [InfraBeat](#)

(<https://infrabeat.com/>) over three months and SAP S/4HANA on Google Cloud

(</solutions/sap/docs/architectures/sap-s4hana-on-gcp>) went live mid-2019. “Our dedicated SAP team worked closely with Infrabeat to deliver the project successfully,” says Sachin. “We needed an experienced partner to assist with the implementation process and Infrabeat performed that role admirably. Both teams supported each other and worked to plan to deliver a great result.”

SAP S/4HANA runs on an infrastructure comprising virtual machine instances delivered through Compute Engine (</compute>), Cloud Storage (</storage>), and Cloud NAT (</nat>) to enable the secure transmission and receipt of packets to and from the internet.

G R Infraprojects Limited estimates the cost of running SAP S/4 HANA in Google Cloud is significantly lower than on alternative infrastructure options—freeing up budget for other business priorities.

In addition, moving SAP S/4 HANA to infrastructure as a service through Google Cloud has eliminated the need to assign internal team members to infrastructure management, allowing them instead to focus on higher-value activities.

Google Cloud also incorporates the security needed to protect the data and processes of SAP S/4 HANA from intrusion or disruption and ensure the uptime and continuity required of a business-critical system.

Optimized speed and availability

G R Infraprojects Limited's decision to run SAP S/4 HANA on Google Cloud is delivering benefits on a daily basis. "With Google Cloud, our speed and availability are controlled and optimized day by day," says Sachin. "We are very happy with the performance."

Success with SAP S/4HANA has helped the business decide to move its remaining apps and data to the cloud when its on-premises servers and other equipment reach end of life. G R Infraprojects Limited is already running Active Directory in Google Cloud and Sachin says the cloud platform's "fast and excellent services" made the decision easy.

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Adding value

As G R Infraprojects Limited grows, Sachin adds, the business expects Google Cloud to continue to add value. “There are definitely instances of various upgrades of our systems and within the organization, and as we talk about our application and mobility requirements, we see Google Cloud playing a crucial role.”



